

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 835

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Jonathan Kerry Blackwood.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Jonathan Kerry Blackwood; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Blackwood was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Jonathan Blackwood was born on June 30, 1947, in Memphis to Jimmie and Alese Blalock Blackwood; he attended public schools in Fayette County and received a degree in history from Tennessee Technological University; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Blackwood earned his Juris Doctor degree from the University of Memphis, and he began his legal career as an assistant district attorney, in which position he served for ten years; and

WHEREAS, Jonathan Blackwood served as the circuit judge for the 25th Judicial District for twenty years before serving as senior judge, covering all ninety-five counties, for the final ten years of his career; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Blackwood was deeply devoted to his family, and he remained true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his wife of fifty years, Julia Jarrell Blackwood; brother, William Steven (Helen) Blackwood; sisters, Brenda (Wayne) Keller and Beverly (Wayne) Smith; and several nieces, nephews, great-nieces, and great-nephews; and

WHEREAS, Jonathan Blackwood was preceded in death by his parents and a nephew, Benjamin Smith; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Blackwood leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Jonathan Kerry Blackwood, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Blackwood.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.